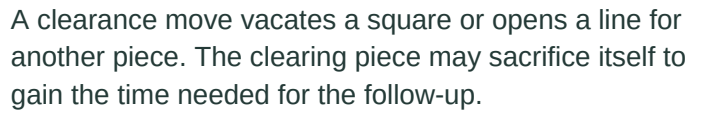


Clearance tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: rook on c1.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Rxa1 The rook captures the rook on a1. Recorded reply: **32.Rxa1**.

33...Rxa1 The rook captures the rook on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.